

OPPORTUNITIES GALORE FOR THOSE WHO CAN GRAB THEM

While exhibiting at the 72nd China Electronics Fair (CEF), we got a chance to interact with 50-plus exhibitors. During our discussion, we realised that CEF could be a hidden opportunity for many Indian firms seeking alliances with Chinese counterparts



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It's China's biggest electronics event. Yet, very few Indian buyers were there. We tried to understand why, and realised that CEF was being seen as more of a domestic event than an international one. While that's been the case in the past, the profile of CEF (and its customers) is now changing. Naturally, when such shifts happen, there are bound to be opportunities for the early-movers. The question

remains—are you one?

The basics

CEF 2008 was held from 12th to 15th November 2008 at the Shanghai New International Expo Center (SNIIEC). Despite the economic crisis, the exhibition occupied an area of 60,000 square metres and there were 1700 exhibitors from 21 countries. To give you a better perspective, this expo was bigger in size than the two biggest electronics shows of India put together.

As per our interaction with a few exhibitors, the number of visitors were not as much as one would expect in an event of this size—but the organisers did report a 10 per cent increase as compared to the last year, and put the total number of visitors at 60,369. The number of overseas visitors increased by 20 per cent.

Seminars conducted at CEF included *China Electronic Component Leaders Summit*, *Sensors & Wireless Innovation Asia Conference*, *The 6th (Shanghai) Automobile Electronics Forum 2008*, *Embedded Technology Innovation and Application Summit* and *China FPD Manufacturing Forum (Shanghai) 2008*.

The next edition of CEF is scheduled to happen at Shenzhen from 9th to 11th April 2009, and is slated to occupy an area of 80,000 square metres!

Interestingly, over 75 per cent of the exhibitors polled, expressed 'full satisfaction' with the event. One-third of those we met felt that the turnout was lower than last year, but were still happy with the quality of the audience and the organisation of the event.

The hidden opportunity

So, should Indian firms be looking at an event that seems like more of an intra-China event? Well, if you look at half-filled glasses as half-full, then the answer is YES! There are major business deals waiting to happen, let me explain why.